

More Contradiction; some Induction

WTF P

Assume $\neg P$

Argue

Conclude Q

Observe Q is false

Conclude P

$$(\neg P \Rightarrow Q) \wedge \neg Q \Rightarrow P$$

$$P \Rightarrow Q$$

$$\neg P \Rightarrow \neg Q$$

Let $n \in \mathbb{Z}$.

Prove that n and $n+1$ have no common prime factors.

Assume n and $n+1$ have a common prime factor P . Then $P|n$ and $P|n+1$.

By the 2 out of 3 rule, $P|1$.

But the smallest prime is $P=2$, so this is a contradiction.

$\square$

$$\Rightarrow P|(n+1) - n$$

$$\Rightarrow P|1$$

(10) Let a, b, c be integers satisfying $a^2 + b^2 = c^2$. Show that abc must be even. (Harder problem: show that a or b must be even.)

Proceed by contradiction. Assume $a, b, \text{ and } c$ are all odd, then $a^2, b^2, \text{ and } c^2$ are odd. But since $a^2 + b^2 = c^2$, the LHS is even, and the RHS is odd. This is a contradiction. $\square$

$$\neg(P \Rightarrow Q) = P \wedge \neg Q$$

(9) Prove that if $r^3 + r + 1 = 0$ then r is irrational.

Proceed by contradiction.

Assume $r^3 + r + 1 = 0$ and $r \in \mathbb{Q}$.

Since $r \in \mathbb{Q}$, $\exists a, b \in \mathbb{Z}$ s.t. $b \neq 0$

and $r = a/b$. Moreover, WMA (we may assume) that a and b are "reduced", i.e., they have no common factors. (In particular, at least one of a or b is odd.) Thus,

$$\left(\frac{a}{b}\right)^3 + \frac{a}{b} + 1 = 0.$$

Clearing denominators

$$a^3 + ab^2 + b^3 = 0 \quad (*)$$

Case 1: a is even. Then b is odd. Then the LHS of $(*)$ is odd, but 0 is even. This is a contradiction.

Case 2: b is even. This is the same as case 1.

Case 3: a and b are both odd. But then the LHS of $(*)$ is odd, but the RHS is even, a contradiction.

We conclude that $r \notin \mathbb{Q}$. $\square$

$$\neg P \Rightarrow \neg(Q_1 \vee Q_2 \vee Q_3)$$

$$\neg(Q_1 \vee Q_2 \vee Q_3) = \neg Q_1 \wedge \neg Q_2 \wedge \neg Q_3$$

$$\log_a x = b \Leftrightarrow x = a^b$$

$$\log_a a^b = b$$

$$\log_a x \text{ and } a^x \text{ are inverses}$$

$$\log_a b = b$$

$$\log_a(a^b) = b$$

$$\log_{10} 100 = 2$$

(13) Prove that $\log_{10} 7$ is irrational.

Proceed by contradiction. Assume that $\log_{10} 7 \in \mathbb{Q}$. Thus, $\exists a, b \in \mathbb{Z}$ s.t.

$$b \neq 0 \text{ and } \log_{10} 7 \stackrel{(*)}{=} a/b. \text{ W.M.A}$$

a & b have no common prime factors. Moreover, at least one of a or b is not negative.

Applying

10^x to equation $(*)$ gives

$$7 = 10^{\log_{10} 7} = 10^{a/b}. \text{ Thus } 7^b = 10^a.$$

(1) If a or b is negative, we get that an integer is equal to a non integer, $\downarrow$

(2) If a and b are both not negative, then, since $b > 0$, the LHS of $(*)$ is a multiple of 7, but the RHS is not a multiple of 7, $\downarrow$.

We conclude that $\log_{10} 7 \notin \mathbb{Q}$. $\square$

$P(n)$

Induction

$\forall n \in \mathbb{Z}_{\geq 0}$

$$1 + 2 + 3 + \dots + n = \sum_{i=1}^n i = \frac{n(n+1)}{2}.$$

Base

case

$$1 = 1 \left(\frac{1+1}{2} \right) = \frac{1 \cdot 2}{2} = 1$$

$$1 + 2 = \frac{1 \cdot 3}{2} + 2 = 2 \left(\frac{1+3}{2} \right) = 2 \left(\frac{4}{2} \right) = \frac{2 \cdot 4}{2}$$

$$1 + 2 + 3 = \frac{2 \cdot 3}{2} + 3 = 3 \left(\frac{2+4}{2} \right) = 3 \left(\frac{6}{2} \right) = \frac{3 \cdot 4}{2}$$

$$1 + 2 + 3 + 4 = \frac{3 \cdot 4}{2} + 4 = 4 \left(\frac{3+5}{2} \right) = 4 \left(\frac{8}{2} \right) = \frac{4 \cdot 5}{2}$$

Proof that

$P(n) \Rightarrow P(n+1)$

Proof: Suppose we already know that

$$1 + 2 + \dots + (n-1) = \frac{(n-1)n}{2}.$$

$P(n)$

Adding n to both sides gives

$$1 + 2 + \dots + (n-1) + n = \frac{(n-1)n}{2} + n.$$

The RHS of this is

$$n \left(\frac{n-1}{2} + 1 \right) = n \left(\frac{n-1+2}{2} \right) = \frac{n(n+1)}{2}.$$

We conclude that $\forall n \in \mathbb{Z}_{\geq 0}$,

$$1 + 2 + \dots + n = \frac{n(n+1)}{2} \quad \square \quad P(n)$$

$P(n) =$

$$\frac{n(n+1)}{2}$$

if

$$1 + 2 + \dots + n = \frac{n(n+1)}{2}$$

Define a sequence $a_1, a_2, a_3, \dots$ as

$$a_1 = 2 = 2^1$$

$$a_n = 2 \cdot a_{n-1}$$

"recursive definition"

$$a_2 = 2 \cdot a_1 = 2 \cdot 2 = 4 = 2^2$$

$$a_3 = 2 \cdot a_2 = 2 \cdot 4 = 8 = 2^3$$

$$a_4 = 2 \cdot a_3 = 2 \cdot 8 = 16 = 2^4$$

⋮

Claim: $\forall n \in \mathbb{Z}_{>0}, a_n = 2^n$

Induction: $2^{n+1} \cdot 2 = 2^n$

$$P(n) = "a_n = 2^n"$$

$$\forall n \in \mathbb{Z}_{>0}, P(n)$$

true by

$$P(1) = "a_1 = 2" \leftarrow \text{definition}$$

BASE

CASE

Assume that $P(n)$ is true, i.e., assume that $a_n = 2^n$. Then $a_{n+1} = 2 \cdot a_n$.

By our hypothesis, $a_{n+1} = 2 \cdot a_n = 2 \cdot 2^n = 2^{n+1}$.

Thus $P(n+1)$ is also true

We conclude that $\forall n > 0, P(n)$.

$$P(n) \Rightarrow$$

$$P(n+1)$$

Induction

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Let $P(n)$ be a statement which depends on an integer n

$$\text{Ex } P(n) = "a_n = a" \quad \text{or} \quad P(n) = "1+2+\dots+n = \frac{n(n+1)}{2}"$$

Goal: Prove $P(n) \forall n \in \mathbb{Z}_{>0}$

Step 1: Prove $P(1)$

"Base case"

Step 2: Prove " $P(n-1) \Rightarrow P(n)$ "

"Inductive step"

"Induction" = $P(1)$ and " $P(n-1) \Rightarrow P(n)$ " $\Rightarrow$
 $\forall n \in \mathbb{Z}_{>0}, P(n)$

~~$P(1), P(2), P(3), P(4), P(5), \dots, P(n-1), P(n), P(n+1), \dots$~~

WTF $\forall n \in \mathbb{Z}_{>1}, P(n)$

$$P(2) \wedge P(n) \Rightarrow P(n+1)$$

WTF $\forall \text{even } n \in \mathbb{Z}_{>0}, P(n).$

$$P(2) \wedge P(n) \Rightarrow P(n+2)$$

$$P(a-1) \Rightarrow P(a) \\ P(a) \Rightarrow P(a+1)$$

3. We want to prove, by induction, that, for every positive integer n ,

$$1^3 + 2^3 + 3^3 + \cdots + n^3 = \frac{n^2(n+1)^2}{4}.$$

a) What is the open statement " $P(n)$ "?

$$P(n) =$$

b) What is the statement " $P(1)$ "? Why is $P(1)$ true?

$$P(1) =$$

c) What is the inductive step? Write out your assumption, your desired conclusion, and the inductive step (i.e., the proof that $P(n-1) \Rightarrow P(n)$).
Assume that

We want to show that

(Inductive step)